Lena Varga-Holm

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with experience owning ingestion and orchestration for a production data platform built on Airflow, Snowflake, dbt, and Kafka. Delivers reliable batch and streaming pipelines, warehouse transformations, data quality controls, and platform improvements. Recent outcomes include processing approximately 30 million shipment events per day at under 2 minutes p95 latency, reducing a nightly warehouse build from 5h10 to 1h35, and lowering monthly Snowflake spend from approximately USD 38,000 to USD 24,000 through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend, and removal of unused tables.

CORE SKILLS

Data platform: Production platform ownership; ingestion and orchestration; batch and streaming pipelines; change data capture (CDC); data quality; operational support
Languages: Python, SQL
Platforms and tools: Airflow, dbt, Snowflake, Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, PySpark, AWS MSK, AWS EMR, Redshift, PostgreSQL, S3, Glue Data Catalog, Terraform, GitHub Actions, Great Expectations, pytest, SSIS

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer | Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. | 2022–Present

- Own ingestion and orchestration for the data platform using Airflow, Snowflake, dbt, and Kafka.
- Designed and built a shipment event streaming pipeline processing approximately 30 million events per day, with end-to-end latency under 2 minutes at p95; added dead-letter and replay tooling to reprocess failed events without data loss.
- Migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into tested and documented dbt models, introducing incremental models and slim CI in GitHub Actions; reduced the nightly warehouse build from 5h10 to 1h35.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from the orders database with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Reduced the monthly Snowflake bill from approximately USD 38,000 to USD 24,000 in 2024 through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend, and removal of unused tables.
- Participate in the data platform on-call rotation, one week in six; mentor two mid-level engineers and run data platform office hours.

Data Engineer | Kovalent Pay | 2019–2022

- Built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR for a transaction reconciliation engine matching bank settlement files against internal ledgers.
- Reduced finance team's manual reconciliation work from approximately three days to four hours per month-end.
- Worked on Redshift warehouse design and data quality using Great Expectations.

Earlier Experience

BI Developer | Adria Retail Group

- Took on most of the ETL work and migrated 60 nightly SSIS packages to Python scripts, making loads easier to debug and change.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATION

MSc in Computer Science | Northgate Technical University
Thesis: Incremental materialized views
AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate | May 2024

COMMUNITY AND OPEN SOURCE

- Teach SQL for beginners at a local women-in-tech meetup, approximately four evenings per year since 2021.
- Presented “Data contracts without the hype” at a regional data meetup in 2024.
- Contributed two merged pull requests to a community Airflow provider for a SaaS CRM API, fixing a pagination bug and adding tests in 2023.